DINNER · POPPY'S KITCHEN

Turkey & Black Bean Cottage Cheese Bake



A layered Tex-Mex tortilla bake where cottage cheese melts in for protein and creaminess.

4, plus a lunch	50 min
SERVES	START TO TABLE
15 min	**35 min**
PREP	COOK

Weeknight, mostly hands-off

🛒 What you need

FROM THE STORE

- ☐ **1¼ lb** Ground turkey 94%
- ☐ **1 can** Bush's black beans, drained and rinsed
- ☐ **1½ cups** Cottage cheese
- ☐ **1 cup** Chunky salsa, mild
- ☐ **1 packet** Taco seasoning
- ☐ **1 cup** Frozen corn
- ☐ **1** Onion, diced
- ☐ **8** Mission soft taco tortillas
- ☐ **2 cups** Mexican blend shredded cheese
- ☐ **to serve** Sour cream

FROM THE PANTRY

- ☐ **1 Tbsp** Olive oil
- ☐ **⅓ cup** Water

⚡ **First:** Oven on to 375°F.

GEAR

9×13 baking dish · Big skillet · Foil

🔥 Let's cook

1. Heat the oven to 375°F. Grease a 9×13 dish.
2. Cook the onion in the oil over medium-high, 3 minutes. Add the turkey, press flat and let it brown before breaking it up. ⏱️ 8 min
3. Stir in the taco seasoning, water, beans, corn and half the salsa. Simmer 3 minutes. ⏱️ 3 min
4. In a bowl mix the cottage cheese, the rest of the salsa and 1 cup of the cheese. 🧒 Kids can do this
5. Layer: 4 tortillas (tear to fit), half the meat, all the cottage cheese mix, 4 more tortillas, the rest of the meat. 🧒 Kids can do this
6. Top with the last cup of cheese. Cover with foil and bake 20 minutes, then uncover 10 more until bubbly. ⏱️ 30 min
7. Rest 5 minutes before cutting so the squares hold. Sour cream on top.



CHEF'S SECRET

Season the cottage cheese layer with salsa and cheese: plain cottage cheese tastes flat, but mixed this way it bakes into a creamy, cheesy middle nobody picks out.

Poppy's draft. Change something? Tell Poppy with 💡 so the card learns.



DINNER · FLIP SIDE

Turkey & Black Bean Cottage Cheese Bake

👩‍🍳 Kitchen crew: kid jobs

- ☐ Stir the cottage cheese, salsa and cheese together
- ☐ Sprinkle the cheese on top
- ☐ Tear tortillas and build the layers
- ☐ Set the table and put out sour cream and salsa

Knives, the stove and the oven: a grown-up stays right there. Steps marked 🧒 **Kids can do this** on the front are theirs to own.

⏰ MAKE IT AHEAD

Assemble up to a day ahead, cover and fridge; add 10 minutes covered.

🥡 LEFTOVERS

Squares reheat great for lunch (microwave 90 seconds or 350°F for 15).

🔁 SWAP IT

- Ground beef instead of turkey
- Pepper jack on top for heat

🍽️ SERVE IT WITH

Shredded lettuce with lime, or Alexia street corn

⏱️ Game plan: everything lands at once

50 min out	Oven to 375°F. Grease the 9×13.
45 min	Onion, then turkey in the skillet to brown.
37 min	Seasoning, beans, corn and salsa in; simmer. Kids mix the cottage cheese.
33 min	Kids layer tortillas, meat and cheese mix in the dish.
30 min	Foil on, into the oven: 20 min covered, 10 uncovered.
5 min	Out of the oven to rest so the squares hold.
Dinner	Cut and serve with sour cream.

Done cooking? Tell Poppy how it went.

Scan to open this meal in Poppy: vote 😍 🙂 😐 👎 and send tweaks with 💡. What you tell Poppy makes this card better next time.